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SEO Strategy

UBIS Global — ABD & Masters Transfer Pathways

Organic search strategy to rank for high-intent, low-competition keywords

Long-tail focus | Content-led | 3-6 month horizon

ubisglobal.com

Strategy Overview

Core Approach

Rank for the same long-tail, high-intent keywords targeted in the paid ads campaign — but organically. These keywords have low competition, meaning realistic ranking in 3-6 months with focused effort.

Why SEO matters for UBIS: Paid ads stop delivering the moment you stop paying. SEO builds a permanent asset. The ABD and transfer niches are underserved — most universities focus their SEO on "MBA online" and "DBA program" (impossible to rank for without massive authority). The long-tail keywords we target have little to no dedicated content competing for them.

Element	ABD Page	Masters Page
Primary keyword cluster	ABD completion, finish dissertation, dissertation help	Transfer masters credits, finish masters fast, credit transfer
Secondary cluster	DBA completion online, doctoral advanced standing	International credit transfer, complete MBA elsewhere
Content type	Landing page + blog support	Landing page + blog support
Target timeline	Rank page 1 in 3-6 months	Rank page 1 in 3-6 months

1. On-Page SEO — Landing Pages

Both landing pages need optimization for search engines while maintaining their conversion-focused design. Here are the specific changes:

ABD Page — SEO Meta & Structure

Meta Title	ABD Dissertation Completion Program Finish Your DBA Online UBIS Global
Meta Description	Stuck on your dissertation? UBIS ABD pathway helps you finish your DBA in ~1 year with rotating faculty mentors. 4 structured tracks from \$800 each. Transfer your credits. Start this week.
Primary H1	You Did the Coursework. Now Finish the Degree.
URL slug	/abd-dissertation-completion
Schema markup	EducationalOrganization + Course + FAQPage

Masters Page — SEO Meta & Structure

Meta Title	Transfer Your Masters Credits Finish in 8 Weeks UBIS Global
Meta Description	Transfer up to 70% of your graduate credits and finish your master's in as few as 8 weeks. From \$2,700. International credits accepted. Free credit evaluation.
Primary H1	You Already Earned the Credits. Don't Pay for Them Again.
URL slug	/masters-credit-transfer
Schema markup	EducationalOrganization + Course + FAQPage

On-Page Optimization Checklist

- ☐ Add target keywords naturally in H2 headings (not just H1)
- ☐ Include keyword-rich alt text on all images/icons
- ☐ Add internal links from ubisglobal.com main site to both landing pages
- ☐ Ensure both pages load in under 3 seconds (currently static HTML — should be fast)
- ☐ Add FAQ schema with 5-8 questions per page (see Section 4)
- ☐ Include target keywords in first 100 words of page copy
- ☐ Add breadcrumb navigation for site structure
- ☐ Ensure mobile-responsive (already done)
- ☐ Add canonical URL tags to prevent duplicate content issues
- ☐ Compress any images added in future (WebP format preferred)

2. Keyword Targeting Map

These are the organic keywords to target, organized by priority and mapped to content.

Tier 1 — Primary Keywords (Target on Landing Pages)

These should be the main focus of each landing page. Low competition, high intent.

Keyword	Page	Est. Volume/mo	Difficulty
ABD completion program	ABD	50-200	Low
finish my dissertation	ABD	100-400	Low
dissertation completion program	ABD	100-300	Low
all but dissertation help	ABD	50-150	Very Low
transfer masters credits	Masters	200-500	Low
transfer graduate credits	Masters	100-300	Low
finish my masters degree	Masters	200-600	Low-Med
complete my masters online	Masters	300-800	Medium

Tier 2 — Secondary Keywords (Target via Blog Content)

Support the landing pages with blog posts that link back to them.

Keyword	Blog Topic	Links To
how to finish a dissertation	"7 Strategies to Finish Your Dissertation When You're Stuck"	ABD page
dissertation help for doctoral students	"When Your Dissertation Advisor Leaves: What to Do Next"	ABD page
ABD to doctorate	"ABD to Doctorate: Your Complete Guide to Finishing"	ABD page
transfer doctoral credits	"How to Transfer Doctoral Credits Between Universities"	ABD page
how many credits can I transfer masters	"How Many Credits Can You Transfer for a Masters Degree?"	Masters page
international credit transfer	"Transferring International Credits to a US Masters Degree"	Masters page
finish masters degree fast	"The Fastest Way to Finish Your Masters Degree in 2026"	Masters page
complete MBA started elsewhere	"How to Complete Your MBA After Starting at Another School"	Masters page

Tier 3 — Long-Tail / Question Keywords (Target via FAQ + Blog)

Keyword / Question	Content Type
can I finish my DBA if I'm ABD?	FAQ on ABD page
how much does it cost to finish a dissertation?	Blog post
what does ABD mean in a doctoral program?	Blog post (top of funnel)
can I transfer credits from another DBA program?	FAQ on ABD page
how long does it take to finish a dissertation?	Blog post
can I finish my masters in one semester?	FAQ on Masters page
do online masters degrees accept transfer credits?	FAQ on Masters page
can I transfer international credits to a US university?	Blog post
what is the maximum credit transfer for a masters?	FAQ on Masters page
is an IACBE accredited degree respected?	Blog post (credibility)

3. Content Strategy

Blog content supports the landing pages by capturing top-of-funnel traffic and building topical authority. Each blog post should link back to the relevant landing page.

Month 1-2: Foundation Content

Post Title	Target Keyword	Word Count	Links To
ABD to Doctorate: Your Complete Guide to Finishing the Dissertation You Started	ABD to doctorate	2,000	ABD page
How Many Credits Can You Transfer for a Masters Degree? (2026 Guide)	how many credits can I transfer masters	1,800	Masters page
7 Strategies to Finish Your Dissertation When You're Stuck	how to finish a dissertation	2,200	ABD page
The Fastest Way to Finish Your Masters Degree in 2026	finish masters degree fast	1,800	Masters page

Month 3-4: Authority Content

Post Title	Target Keyword	Word Count	Links To
When Your Dissertation Advisor Leaves: What to Do Next	dissertation help for doctoral students	1,500	ABD page
Transferring International Credits to a US Masters Degree	international credit transfer	2,000	Masters page
How to Transfer Doctoral Credits Between Universities	transfer doctoral credits	1,800	ABD page
How to Complete Your MBA After Starting at Another School	complete MBA started elsewhere	1,600	Masters page

Month 5-6: Top-of-Funnel + Credibility

Post Title	Target Keyword	Word Count	Links To
What Does ABD Mean? Everything Doctoral Candidates Need to Know	what does ABD mean	1,500	ABD page
Is an IACBE-Accredited Degree Respected by Employers?	IACBE accredited degree respected	1,800	Both pages
How Much Does It Cost to Finish a Dissertation?	cost to finish dissertation	1,500	ABD page
Online Masters vs On-Campus: Which Is Right for Working Professionals?	online masters working professionals	1,800	Masters page

Content Rules

- Every blog post must link to the relevant landing page (contextual, not forced)
- Every blog post must have a unique meta title and description
- Include at least 1 internal link to ubisglobal.com main site
- Target 1,500-2,200 words per post (enough depth to rank)
- Include original data, charts, or tables where possible (Google favors these)
- Update posts every 6 months to keep them fresh

4. FAQ Schema — Featured Snippet Strategy

FAQ schema markup helps pages appear in Google's "People Also Ask" boxes and featured snippets. Add these to each landing page.

ABD Page — FAQ Schema Questions

#	Question	Answer (short)
1	What does ABD mean?	ABD stands for "All But Dissertation" — it means you've completed all doctoral coursework but haven't finished your dissertation.
2	Can I finish my DBA if I'm ABD from another school?	Yes. UBIS accepts up to 40 credits of advanced standing and admits you directly to the dissertation phase. No coursework repetition.
3	How long does it take to finish a dissertation at UBIS?	Most ABD students complete their dissertation in about 1 year through our 4 structured tracks.
4	How much does it cost to finish a dissertation?	Dissertation tracks are \$800 each (4 tracks = \$3,200) plus program fees. Total cost is typically under \$9,000.
5	Do I get a faculty advisor?	Yes — and more. UBIS uses a rotating faculty model where a specialist is matched to you at each phase of your dissertation.
6	Can I transfer my PhD coursework to a DBA?	Yes. UBIS conducts a comprehensive prior learning assessment and may award up to 40 credits toward advanced standing.

Masters Page — FAQ Schema Questions

#	Question	Answer (short)
1	How many credits can I transfer to a masters program?	UBIS accepts up to 70% of required credits — 2 to 3 times the industry norm of 25-33%.
2	Can I finish my masters in one semester?	With maximum transfer, you may only need 3 courses. Taking them concurrently in one 8-week term means you finish in 8 weeks.
3	Do you accept international credits?	Yes. UBIS applies recognized international grade equivalency standards and evaluates transcripts from universities worldwide.
4	How much does it cost to finish a masters with transfer credits?	With maximum transfer, out-of-pocket cost starts from approximately \$2,700.
5	Is an online masters degree from UBIS accredited?	Yes. UBIS is IACBE-accredited, which is recognized by CHEA (Council for Higher Education Accreditation).
6	Can I take multiple courses at the same time?	Yes. Students can take up to 3 courses concurrently in a single 8-week term.
7	When can I start?	UBIS has approximately 9 entry dates per year with new intakes every week. No waiting for traditional semester starts.

5. Technical SEO

Site Architecture

Recommended URL structure on ubisglobal.com:

ubisglobal.com/abd-dissertation-completion
ubisglobal.com/masters-credit-transfer
[ubisglobal.com/blog/\[post-slug\]](https://ubisglobal.com/blog/[post-slug])

Technical Checklist

- ☐ Submit XML sitemap to Google Search Console
- ☐ Set up Google Search Console for ubisglobal.com (if not already done)

- ❑ Set up Google Analytics 4 with conversion events
- ❑ Ensure HTTPS is enforced site-wide
- ❑ Add robots.txt allowing all search engines
- ❑ Implement structured data (JSON-LD) for EducationalOrganization
- ❑ Add FAQPage schema to both landing pages
- ❑ Ensure pages pass Core Web Vitals (LCP < 2.5s, FID < 100ms, CLS < 0.1)
- ❑ Add Open Graph tags for social sharing
- ❑ Set up 301 redirects if any old URLs exist
- ❑ Ensure no duplicate content (canonical tags on all pages)
- ❑ Add hreflang tags if targeting international markets with localized pages

Page Speed Targets

Metric	Target	Current (Static HTML)
Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)	< 2.5s	Should be < 1s (static HTML)
First Input Delay (FID)	< 100ms	Should be < 10ms (minimal JS)
Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS)	< 0.1	Should be 0 (fixed layout)
Page size	< 1MB	~20-30KB per page (excellent)

Speed Advantage

Both landing pages are pure static HTML with minimal JavaScript. They should score 95-100 on Google PageSpeed Insights out of the box. This is a significant ranking advantage over competitor pages built on heavy CMS platforms.

6. Backlink Strategy

Backlinks remain one of the strongest ranking signals. Here's how to build them for UBIS without a large budget.

Tier 1 — High-Value, Low-Effort Links

Tactic	Effort	Expected Links	Timeline
University directory submissions — Submit UBIS to online degree directories (OnlineU, BestColleges, DegreeDirectory)	Low	5-10	1-2 weeks
Accreditation body listing — Ensure UBIS is listed on IACBE's website with a link	Low	1	Already done?
HELC listing — Ensure link from Higher Education Learning Commission	Low	1	Already done?
Partner cross-links — AIU and CCI partners link to UBIS ABD/transfer pages	Medium	2-5	2-4 weeks
Press release — Announce the ABD pathway or transfer program via PR Newswire or similar	Medium	5-15	1-2 weeks

Tier 2 — Content-Driven Links

Tactic	Effort	Expected Links	Timeline
Guest posts — Write for education blogs, adult learner sites, career advancement publications	High	2-4/month	Ongoing
Expert quotes — Respond to journalist queries on HARO/Connectively about doctoral completion, credit transfer	Medium	1-3/month	Ongoing
Original research — Publish a "State of ABD Completion" report with original data (even survey data from current students)	High	10-30	2-3 months
Resource pages — Find university "finish your degree" resource pages and request inclusion	Low	5-10	2-4 weeks

Tier 3 — Community & Social Signals

Tactic	Effort	Impact
Reddit — Participate in r/GradSchool, r/PhD, r/GetStudying with genuine advice (link when relevant)	Medium	Traffic + brand
Quora — Answer questions about ABD, dissertation help, credit transfer with links to relevant pages	Low	Traffic + authority
LinkedIn — Publish articles about doctoral completion and credit transfer; link to landing pages	Medium	Traffic + brand
Medium — Republish blog content on Medium with canonical links back to ubisglobal.com	Low	Authority signal

7. Local & International SEO

Google Business Profile

- ☐ Claim/verify Google Business Profile for UBIS at 1100 15th Street NW, Washington DC
- ☐ Add "Online University" and "Graduate School" as categories
- ☐ Post weekly updates about ABD pathway and transfer program
- ☐ Encourage student reviews (especially ABD completers and transfer graduates)
- ☐ Add photos of campus (even if virtual), faculty, and graduation

International Targeting

Market	Approach	Priority
Nigeria	Dedicated blog posts about transferring Nigerian university credits to US masters. Target keywords: "transfer Nigerian credits US masters"	High
India	Content about US-accredited online masters for Indian professionals. Target: "US masters degree online India"	High
UK	Content about converting UK masters credits to US DBA. Target: "UK PhD credits transfer US"	Medium
UAE / Saudi Arabia	Content about US-accredited degrees for Gulf professionals. Target: "US accredited online MBA UAE"	Medium

8. Tracking & Measurement

Key Metrics

Metric	Tool	Target (6 months)
Organic traffic to ABD page	Google Analytics 4	500+ sessions/month
Organic traffic to Masters page	Google Analytics 4	800+ sessions/month
Keyword rankings (Tier 1)	Google Search Console	Page 1 for 5+ keywords
Keyword rankings (Tier 2)	Google Search Console	Page 1-2 for 10+ keywords
Backlinks acquired	Ahrefs / SEMrush / GSC	30+ new referring domains
Domain Authority	Moz / Ahrefs	+5 point increase
Organic conversion rate	Google Analytics 4	3-5% (calculator interaction)
Blog traffic	Google Analytics 4	1,000+ sessions/month

Monthly Review Process

- ☐ Review Google Search Console for new keyword impressions and clicks
- ☐ Check rankings for Tier 1 and Tier 2 keywords
- ☐ Identify new keyword opportunities from "Queries" report
- ☐ Review blog post performance — double down on what works
- ☐ Check for new backlinks and disavow any spam links
- ☐ Update FAQ schema with new questions based on Search Console data
- ☐ Review page speed scores (monthly)
- ☐ Report organic traffic and conversions vs. paid campaign performance

9. Why UBIS Can Win Organically

1

Niche focus — ABD completion and high-transfer masters are underserved niches. Most universities don't create dedicated content for these audiences.

2

Low competition — The long-tail keywords targeted have few dedicated pages competing. Page 1 is achievable without massive domain authority.

3

Static HTML speed — Both pages are pure HTML. They load instantly, giving a Core Web Vitals advantage over WordPress-heavy competitor sites.

4

Content moat — 12 planned blog posts create a topical cluster that signals authority to Google on ABD and credit transfer topics.

5

Paid + organic synergy — Paid ads generate immediate data on which keywords convert. Feed that data back into SEO to prioritize the highest-value keywords.

6

International angle — Few US universities create content specifically for international credit transfer. This is a blue ocean for organic search.

10. Quick Start Checklist

- ☐ Update meta titles and descriptions on both landing pages (see Section 1)
- ☐ Submit both pages to Google Search Console for indexing
- ☐ Add FAQ schema markup to both pages (see Section 4)
- ☐ Set up Google Analytics 4 with calculator interaction tracking

- ❑ Create XML sitemap and submit to Google Search Console
- ❑ Write and publish first 4 blog posts (Month 1-2 content)
- ❑ Submit UBIS to 5+ online degree directories
- ❑ Set up Google Business Profile (if not already done)
- ❑ Begin HARO/Connectively responses for expert quote opportunities
- ❑ Request cross-links from AIU and CCI partners
- ❑ Publish first LinkedIn article linking to a landing page
- ❑ Schedule monthly SEO review (first review at 30 days)

Expected Results Timeline

Month 1: Pages indexed, initial impressions in Search Console

Month 2-3: Blog content published, first keyword rankings appear

Month 4-6: Tier 1 keywords reach page 1, organic traffic grows 20-40% month-over-month

Month 6-12: Sustainable organic traffic of 1,000-3,000 sessions/month across both pages